Depression: Some drugs act by decreasing the activity of specialised cells, eg., general anaesthetics depress the central nervous system.

Irritation: Certain drugs on topical application can cause irritation of the skin and the adjacent tissues, eg., eucalyptus oil.

Replacement: When there is a deficiency of endogenous substances, they can be replaced by drugs, eg., Insulin.

Chemotherapeutic: Drugs are selectively toxic to infective organism or cancer cells, eg., antibiotics, anticancer drugs.

11.11.2 Effects of Drugs on the Body

THERAPEUTIC EFFECTS: It is the expected or predictable physiological response of medication. The drugs are administered for the following purpose.

1. **TO PROMOTE HEALTH;-** Drugs are given to the individual to increase the resistance against diseases (e.g. vitamins).
2. **TO PREVENT DISEASES;-** (e.g. vaccines and anti-toxins).
3. **TO DIAGNOSE DISEASE:-** (e.g. barium used in the X-ray studies).
4. **TO ALLEVIATE DISEASES:-** Certain drugs are given for the palliative effect or for the temporary relief of distressing symptoms but does not remove the cause or cure the disease (e.g. analgesics)
5. **TO TREAT OR CURE A DISEASE:-**
   - By restoring normal functions (e.g. digoxin).
   - By destroying the causative organisms (e.g. quinine in malaria.)

Local and Systemic Effects

Local effects of a drug are expected when they are applied topically to the skin or mucus membrane.

A drug used for systemic effect must be absorbed into the blood stream to produce the desired effects in the various systems and parts of the body.

Adverse Effects:

Adverse effect is any effect other than the therapeutic effect. These are generally considered severe responses to medication.

Side Effects:

Side effect are the minor adverse effects side effects can harmful or harmless.

Allergic Reactions:

A client can react to a drug as a foreign body and thus develop symptoms of allergic reaction. Allergic reaction can be either severe or mild. A severe allergic reaction usually occurs immediately after the administration of the drugs it is called *anaphylactic reaction*. A mild reaction has a variety of symptoms. From skin rashes to diarrhoea. Such as:

SKIN RASHES: (urticaria) Oedematous pink-ish elevation with itching .

PRURITIS: Itching of the skin with or without a rash.

RHINITIS: Excessive watery discharge from the nose.

LACRIMAL TEARING: Excessive tears from the eyes.

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